

HALF/WHOLE DIMINISHED & TRIADS

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #157

The Half Whole Diminished scale is a device and sound that most intermediate jazz players happen upon, and one that creates a good number of headaches. For many of us, to begin with, it just sounds like a parade of wrong notes. It is akin to a line of hot stoves that we are coached to touch, over and over again. Not a lot of fun, really.

Super Pro Tip - don't treat this scale like a scale. Let's see if we can find some organization inside it that will help us make some sense out of this thing. Something that ideally 1) we easily understand, and 2) we already know and use. If you are hip enough to be looking at this page and watching Digging Deeper Jazz videos, then you are hip enough to know a couple major triads. Let's put them to good use!

#1 - C Half Whole Diminished Scale



This "symmetrical" scale is constructed by alternating half steps and whole steps as we ascend.

#2 - The four major triads from the C Half Whole Diminished scale



#3 - Using different inversions of the triad

